

Sales Training Debrief — Session 14

Frame It. Don't Spin It.

Sales training led by Corie Dawson, Director · Monday 25 May 2026 · Marketing Sweet

1. Know your numbers cold

The session opened with a debrief on the prior Friday's meetings. The numbers were fuzzy — “think it was seven,” “maybe six,” “one of them was a phone call.” That fuzziness is the first failure of framing. You can't frame a result you can't state.

If you walk into a leadership conversation guessing at how many meetings you had, how many attended, how many closed, you have already lost the framing battle before the conversation starts. The leader has to dig the wins out of you, instead of you presenting them. That is the wrong order.

“How many meetings did you have? It's a simple question. There should be no guesswork.”

The discipline:

- Know exactly how many meetings were booked, attended, and closed before you walk into the debrief.
- Distinguish between booked and attended. The gap between them is part of the story and changes the close rate maths.
- Numbers ready means numbers ready — not “let me check.” If you have to check, you weren't prepared.

2. “What are you doing about it?” — actions, not plans

The second movement of the session was about the recruitment problem the lead-gen leads have been carrying for weeks. Every conversation about it has been a conversation about plans. “I have an ad up.” “I've got a plan in place.” “I asked someone what they think.”

Plans are not actions. The leadership question is sharper: what did you actually do this week? Who did you actually speak to? How many people did you actually approach?

“I'm not interested in plans. What are you doing? Like, what did you do on the weekend?”

The pattern to avoid:

- Hiding behind preparation. Designing the ad. Rewriting the post. Discussing the strategy. None of these are actions — they are deferred actions.
- Outsourcing recruitment to one person. Relying on one warm contact is a single point of failure. When that person leaves or runs dry, you are exposed.
- Quick-fix thinking. The expectation that one ad, one post, one conversation will produce the team. It won't. The maths is the same as cold-calling — 70 conversations to fill a handful of seats.

The fix is mechanical: every week, count the conversations you actually started about recruitment. Family events, the pub, the gym, the football. Then bring that count to the debrief without being asked.

3. Discipline beats outcomes

The deepest principle in the session: outcomes are not the goal — disciplines are. The outcomes show up automatically when the disciplines are kept. The reverse is not true: chasing outcomes without disciplines just produces stress and bad decisions.

"I don't care about outcomes as much as you like to believe. I just know that by the right habits and the right disciplines, the outcome occurs. You don't have a choice."

How this applies day-to-day:

- If you make the calls and follow the script, the deals that were going to close anyway will close. You don't have a choice.
- If you approach the conversations with energy and consistency, some of those conversations turn into people. You don't have a choice.
- If you don't do the calls, none of that maths can run. There is no luck on the table to manufacture.

The reframe of "luck":

"I'm the most unlucky person you'll ever meet. But I manufacture my luck by constantly trying and trying and trying."

4. Hand over hand — the handwritten report

Reporting into the leader will move from typed to handwritten. This is not a control mechanism — it is a learning mechanism. There is something that happens when the pen and the hand work together that does not happen with typing. The information sinks deeper, the gaps become obvious, the act of writing forces reflection.

The same principle applies to thank-you letters, customer follow-ups, and recognition: a handwritten card carries more weight than the same words sent by email. The medium changes how the message is received — and how strongly the writer absorbs it.

THE PRINCIPLE Friction in the writing creates clarity in the thinking. Hand it over hand.

5. Acknowledge the ranking — ego to the side

Before training can work, one thing has to be true: the person being coached has to acknowledge that the coach has more to offer in this domain. Without that acknowledgement, every piece of guidance gets second-guessed, every instruction gets debated, every technique gets watered down before it's used.

"If I argued with you about every single thing in your discipline — or worse, just did what I wanted because I thought it was better — what would happen?"

The judo analogy lands hard: a black-belt coach gives a correction, and the student doesn't argue. They try it. They feel it. They decide later whether it served them. The same applies to sales coaching. If the coach has more reps, more wins, more failures, and more time in the game, the right move is to take the instruction, run it, and judge the result — not pre-judge the instruction.

Why this matters for the work:

- If you follow the technique exactly and it doesn't work, the responsibility shifts to the leader. That is freeing — it removes the pressure to invent.
- If you half-follow the technique, every miss becomes ambiguous. You can't tell whether the technique failed or whether your version of it failed.
- Acknowledgement isn't submission. It's the precondition for compounding skills quickly.

6. Framing — the main lesson

The central skill of the session. Framing is the act of presenting facts in the form most useful to the next decision — not spinning them, not exaggerating them, just framing them with the relevant detail in the foreground.

The example given was the Friday debrief. Two ways to present the same facts:

POORLY FRAMED	WELL FRAMED
"We had ten meetings, only closed three."	"We attended four meetings, closed three — 75%."
Focuses on the 60% that didn't happen.	Focuses on the 40% that did, and the win rate inside it.
Sets up the next meeting with disappointment.	Sets up the next meeting with momentum.
The leader has to dig for the win.	The win is presented first, problems get the airtime they deserve.
Reads as excuses dressed up as numbers.	Reads as a precise account of what worked.

Framing is not spin. Spin distorts the facts to make yourself look good. Framing presents the facts — correctly — with the meaningful denominator. The denominator is the whole game: ten booked vs four attended is the same data, but the close rate looks completely different against each one.

"Frame it the way you want it to be framed. That's why I'm trying to explain this to you. This is sales training, and this is so important, because if you don't frame it correctly, you can't go to the next deal with the right mindset."

Where framing lives in the day:

- Before the meeting. Walk in framed — you've closed three this week, you know your stack, you're ready to add to the tally.
- After the meeting. State the win first. Then the gap. Don't bury the win under a story about the gap.

- In the debrief. Lead with what you did, what worked, what you learned. The leader can ask for the rest.
- In your own head between meetings. The frame you carry from meeting to meeting determines the energy you walk in with.

7. Keep the smog out of your head

The brain was described as a city. Every day people will try to put smog into it — negativity, suspicion, doubt, framing your work as something other than what it is. Customers will do it. Colleagues will do it. Family will do it. Strangers will do it.

“You’re putting smog into your head. People can’t help themselves. So your job is to fill your brain with so much positive that there’s no room for the toxins to settle.”

Why this matters for sales specifically:

- A salesperson with a smog-filled head walks into the next call carrying the previous call’s rejection. The customer can feel it.
- A salesperson whose brain is well-framed walks into the next call with the previous call’s win. The customer can feel that too.
- The brain doesn’t respect the difference between someone else’s negativity and your own — once it’s in there, it operates the same way.

The defence is not to argue with the smog. It is to crowd it out. Be the first person to frame the day. Notice what worked. Write it down. Say it out loud. Use the wins as the dominant input, so doubt arrives to a room with no spare space.

8. The display cabinet — a manager’s energy is broadcast

Once you have direct reports, you don’t get to feel privately anymore. Whatever you are carrying internally — stress, frustration, drift, fatigue — is being absorbed by the team around you. Managers are in a display cabinet 24/7. The team is reading you constantly.

“There’s a duty of care for other people’s emotions. If you walk in flat, that flatness passes straight on to your team.”

Two principles to hold simultaneously:

1. Be grateful but mildly unsatisfied. Gratitude is the floor — it keeps you from sliding into the lack mindset. Mild dissatisfaction is the ceiling — it keeps you reaching for the next step.
2. Beat yourself up quietly. The internal high standard is yours. The external face the team sees is upbeat, prepared, deliberate. The team needs to see who they’re trying to become.

The test from the session: if you asked every person on the team to describe the leader they want to be near — high energy, curious, asks about your weekend, never visibly negative — are you that person from the outside, regardless of what you’re feeling internally?

9. Play the long game — plant the seed, don't reap on day one

Several of the recruitment conversations from the weekend were judged in the moment as failures because nobody said “yes, I'll come work for you” on the spot. That expectation is the failure, not the result.

“My expectation is you drop a hand grenade and four weeks later they call you back. You don't go in for the kill on day one. That's creepy. It's not Wolf of Wall Street.”

The long-game playbook:

3. Plant the seed. Mention what you do, mention how good it is, leave it there.
4. Stay in light contact. Quick check-ins later, not pitches. “How's work going?” not “Have you decided yet?”
5. Let the bad day do the closing. Everyone has a rough week eventually. When they do, the seed you planted weeks earlier is the first thing they reach for.
6. Track quietly. Don't expect linear returns from individual conversations. Expect compounding returns from consistent activity.

Power language sits alongside the long game. “I reckon” and “maybe” and “we'll see” pull authority out of every sentence. “Absolutely,” “done,” “it's happening” put it back in. Words you choose are the frame the listener uses to receive what you said.

10. Kaizen — find what worked, do more of that

Framing connects directly to the principle of continuous improvement. The reason you frame factually — stating the wins clearly — is so you can identify what worked and repeat it. If you bury the wins under a story of failure, you can't see what to repeat.

“Figure out what you've done well. Do less of what you didn't do well. Use that time to put it towards the winning stuff.”

The trap to avoid: framing a real win as not enough, then dropping the activity that produced it. “I spoke to four people, didn't get four yeses, so it didn't work, so I'll stop.” That is the average-person trap. The four conversations were the win. The yes is the by-product.

The simple test for every activity this week:

- Did this activity move me, even a little? → do more of it.
- Was this activity a story I told myself instead of an action? → do less of it.
- Did I frame it accurately to myself afterwards? → if not, what was the real ratio?

11. Action items this week

7. Walk into every debrief with exact numbers — booked, attended, closed — ready to state before being asked.
8. Switch to handwritten reporting for the structured reports back to leadership.
9. Frame every result by stating the win first, then the gap. Practice it out loud before the meeting if you have to.

10. Count recruitment conversations, not recruitment plans. Bring the count to the debrief.
11. Pick one piece of coaching this week and run it exactly as instructed — no edits. Note what changed.
12. Audit your own energy as it lands on the team. If you wouldn't want to work for the version of yourself walking in this week, change the version that walks in.
13. Stop expecting same-day yes from recruitment conversations. Plant. Check in. Wait for the bad day.
14. Use power words — “absolutely,” “done” — in at least three conversations this week and notice the response shift.

THE ONE-LINER You can't frame what you can't count. State the numbers. Lead with the win. Plant the seed. Stay in the work.